QC Checklist

AutoHDR · Quality Control

October 13, 2026

IMAGE QUALITY

- [ ] **Distortion — verticals straight**
  Vertical lines (walls, door frames, corners) should be vertical, horizons level, no excessive wide-angle bowing. Perfect: straight, level, natural perspective.

ARTIFACTS & AI ERRORS

- [ ] **Warped or melted lines**
  AI enhancement can bend straight lines or smear textures. Check door frames, cabinetry, railings, window grids, tile, and trim. Perfect: straight lines stay straight, patterns stay regular, textures look real.

LIGHTING & EXPOSURE

- [ ] **Reflections & hotspots**
  Glare on floors, glass, and glossy surfaces from flash or sun. Perfect: even, natural light with no distracting bright spots.

DISTRACTIONS TO REMOVE

- [ ] **Rig reflections — no photographer or tripod visible**
  The photographer, tripod, or drone showing in windows, mirrors, TVs, ovens, and shiny fixtures. Perfect: no equipment or person visible anywhere in the frame.

IMAGE QUALITY

- [ ] **Sharpness & focus**
  No soft or blurry shots; the main subject must be crisp. Perfect: tack-sharp where it matters.

- [ ] **Color consistency**
  Walls, floors, and ceilings should read the same color across the whole set; correct white balance with no green or magenta cast. Perfect: neutral, consistent color gallery-wide.

- [ ] **Duplicates & misfires removed**
  Near-identical frames, test shots, and accidental captures. Perfect: one best frame per composition; no duplicates or misfires delivered.

ARTIFACTS & AI ERRORS

- [ ] **Unnatural blending**
  Especially on twilight and virtual-staging outputs: light glowing in the wrong place, skies that do not match the scene, furniture that does not sit on the floor. Perfect: the edit looks like a real photograph, not a composite.

- [ ] **Ghosting — foliage and moving elements**
  When foliage, branches, flags, or water moved between brackets, AutoHDR can leave semi-transparent or doubled ghost edges. Check all greenery and any moving element outside windows. Perfect: foliage is solid, single, and crisp. Re-run with de-ghosting or pick a cleaner bracket if you see it.

DISTRACTIONS TO REMOVE

- [ ] **Personal items**
  Family photos, mail, documents with names, calendars, fridge magnets and notes, toiletries, medicine, laundry, pet bowls, and trash bins. Perfect: depersonalized and clean — nothing that identifies the occupants or clutters a surface.

- [ ] **General clutter**
  Stray objects on counters, open toilet lids, soap bottles, dish racks, cords on desks, items on the floor. Perfect: clean, styled surfaces.

LIGHTING & EXPOSURE

- [ ] **Blown-out windows**
  Windows must never read as pure white. The view outside — trees, sky, water, lawn — must be visible and naturally exposed. Check every window in every image. Perfect: you can see through every window to a balanced exterior that matches the daylight in the room.

- [ ] **Dark or under-exposed areas**
  Corners, ceilings, under cabinets, hallways, and rooms lit only by ambient light. Shadows should be lifted enough to show detail without going muddy or gray. Perfect: you can see into every corner; blacks are clean, not crushed or milky.

- [ ] **Over-exposed highlights**
  Blown highlights on white walls, countertops, bedding, and bright fixtures. Recover detail so texture is visible. Perfect: whites are bright and clean but still show texture — not a flat white blob.

- [ ] **Window masking — edges clean**
  The exterior pull should be cleanly masked at every window edge. No white glow or light bleed spilling onto the frame, mullions, or wall, and no dark halo. Perfect: crisp window edges, exterior sitting naturally inside the frame.

ARTIFACTS & AI ERRORS

- [ ] **Halos on edges**
  Bright outlines around rooflines, tree lines, and window frames after HDR or sky work. Perfect: clean edges with no glow.

DISTRACTIONS TO REMOVE

- [ ] **Wires & cords**
  TV and console cables, charger cords, lamp and speaker wires, visible cabling along baseboards. Perfect: removed or minimized so no cords distract the eye.

- [ ] **TV screens**
  Default is a clean black screen unless the client rule says otherwise. No reflections of the room, camera, or photographer in the screen. Perfect: screen treatment matches the client rule; no reflections visible.

- [ ] **Fireplace — fire added where applicable**
  Add a realistic fire where the fireplace is a feature and it suits the listing or season. Perfect: natural flame with a believable glow and correct color — never cartoonish or oversized.

IMAGE QUALITY

- [ ] **Noise & grain**
  Check shadows and darker rooms for grain. Perfect: clean, smooth shadows.

ADD-ONS

- [ ] **Twilight — sky gradient and interior glow balanced**
  Sky preset looks natural for the time of day. Interior lighting glows warmly without blowing out windows. Add suffix DTE / twilight. Deliver with the main set unless client requests separate delivery.